



Individual Instructor Report Fall 2024 Version B for STA 235H - DATA SCI FOR BUSN APPS: HON (05225) (Henrique Bolfarine)

Project Title: **Course Evaluations Fall 2024**

Courses Audience: **43**

Responses Received: **43**

Response Ratio: **100%**

Report Comments

Guide to the Interpretation of Course Evaluations at UT Austin

The goal of course evaluation process at UT Austin is to drive teaching excellence and to support continuous improvement in teaching and learning experiences. The two sets of scales used for core evaluation questions and the associated weights are:

Strongly Agree (5)
Agree (4)
Neutral (3)
Disagree (2)
Strongly Disagree (1)

Excellent (5)
Very Good (4)
Satisfactory (3)
Unsatisfactory (2)
Very Unsatisfactory (1)

The Mean is calculated by adding all of the weights for a single question and dividing by the number of respondents. The course workload question is not averaged.

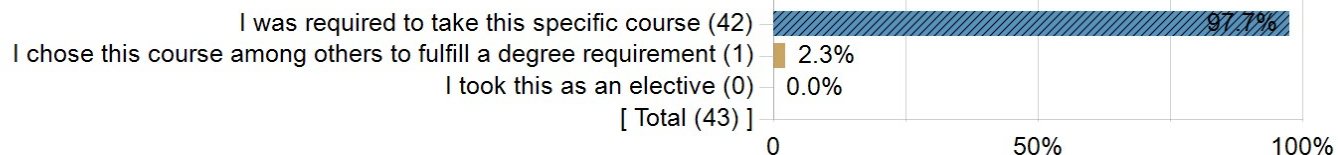
The number of students (e.g. respondents) marking each option is reported for each of the items. These frequency distributions provide information about the level of student ratings and the spread and shape of the class distribution of responses. The distributions thus provide a picture of student perception of a course.

Course evaluations provide snapshots of student perspectives on their course-level learning experiences. Most experts on teaching evaluation advise that no individual method gives the complete picture of an instructor's teaching effectiveness; multiple and diverse measures, on multiple occasions, are advised to give a full picture of the teaching effectiveness of a particular instructor. Moreover, other factors, such as size of class, level of the class, and content of the course, can cause small variations in the ratings. Therefore, student perspectives for a particular instructor or course should be interpreted as a snapshot, and not as providing complete information on the teaching effectiveness of that instructor.

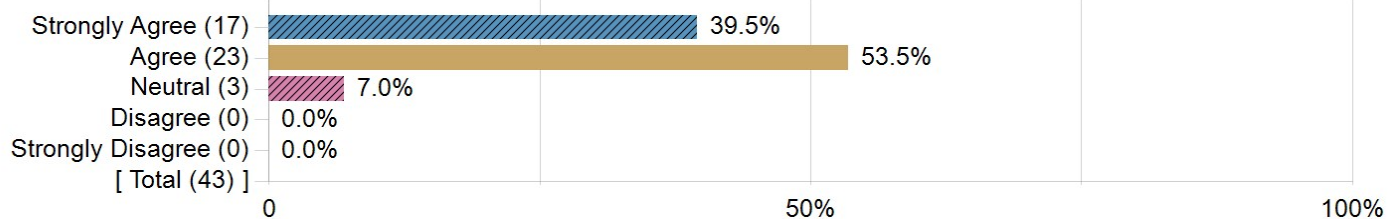
Creation Date: **Thursday, January 23, 2025**

Course Questions

Why did you take this course?

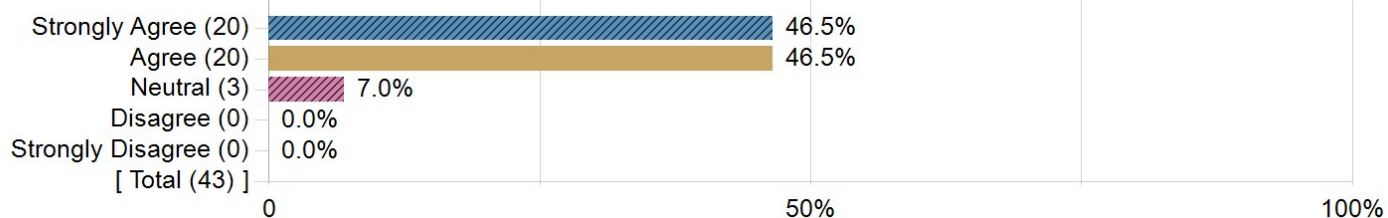


During this course, I gained a deeper understanding of the subject matter.



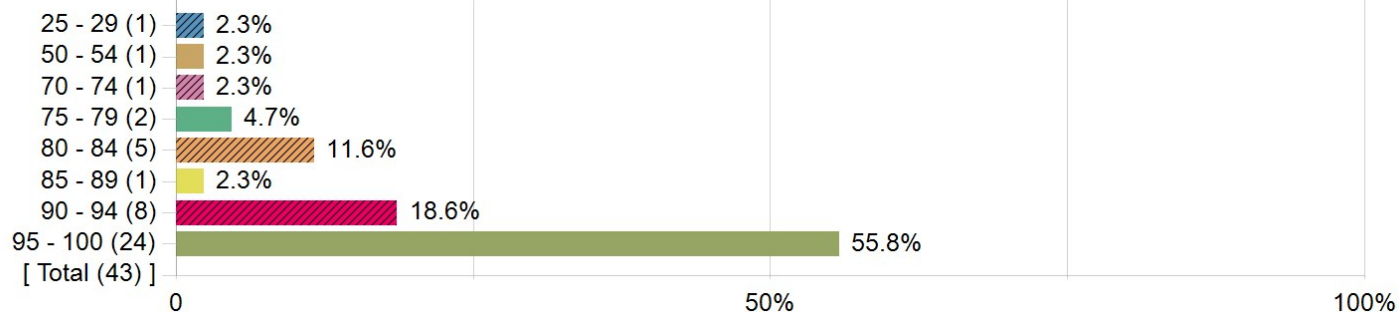
Statistics	Value
Mean	4.33

The course was well organized.



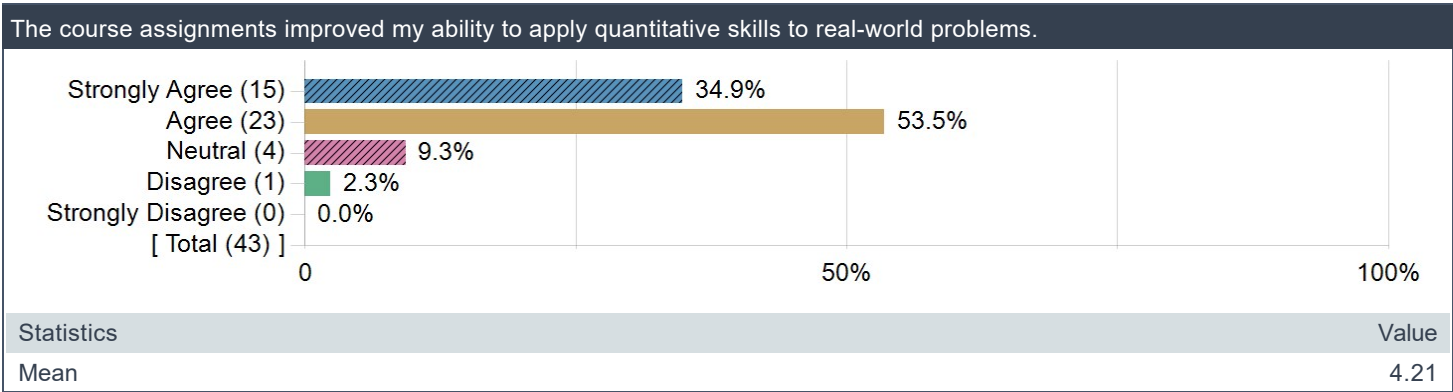
Statistics	Value
Mean	4.40

Overall, approximately what percentage of the course meetings did you attend or complete (online, in person, or asynchronously)?



Statistics	Value
Mean	90.58

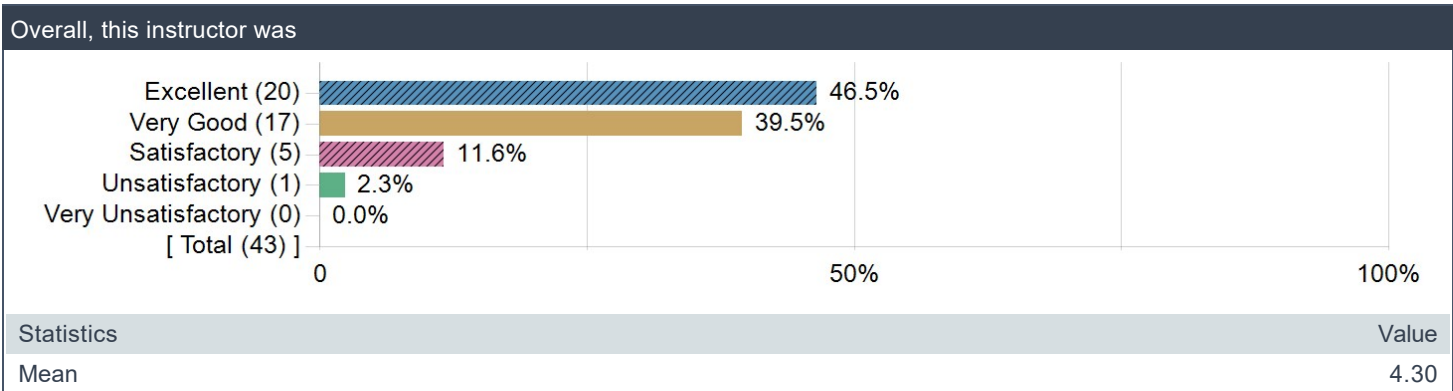
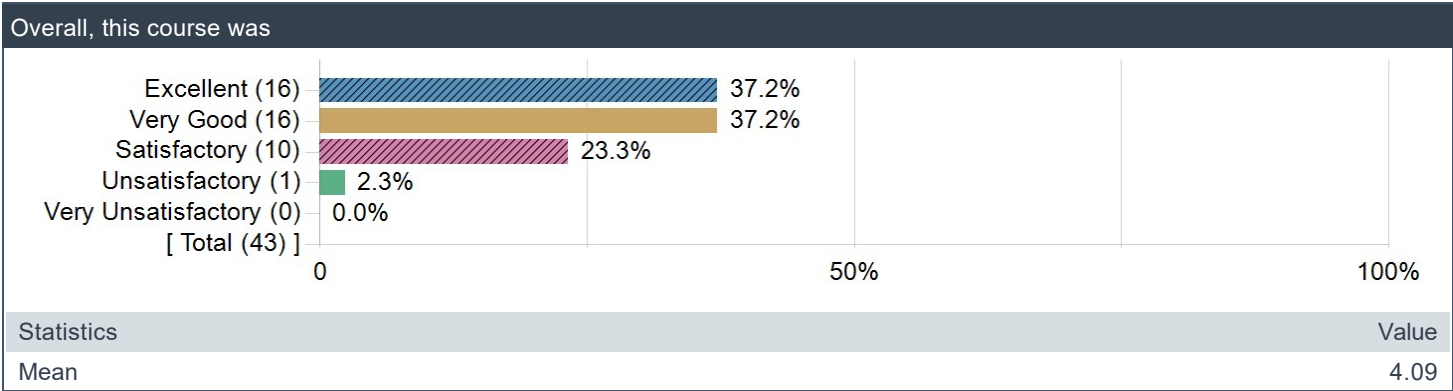
The course assignments improved my ability to apply quantitative skills to real-world problems. (Flag Question)



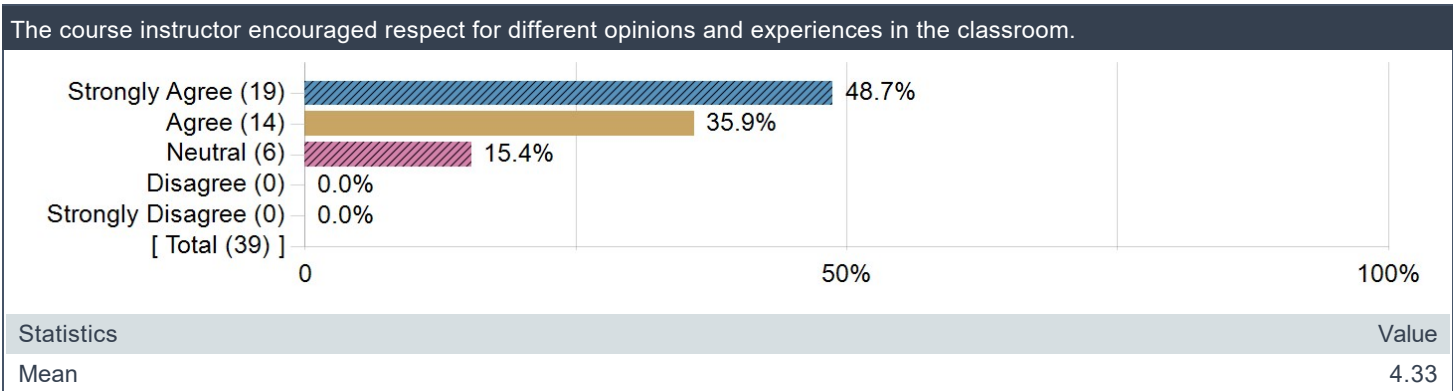
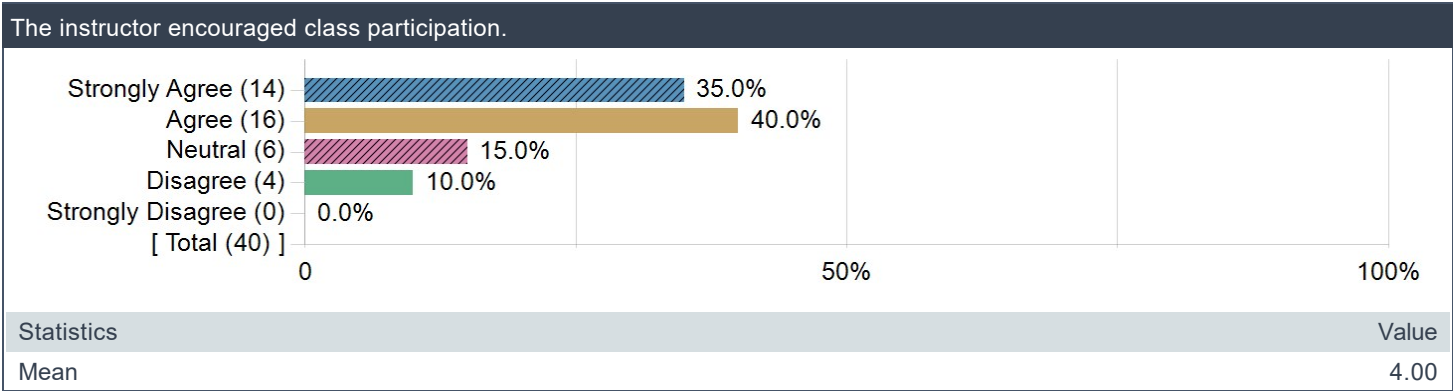
Instructor Questions

	Strongly Agree	Agree	Neutral	Disagree	Strongly Disagree	Responded	Mean
The instructor clearly explained the course objectives and expectations.	44.2%	53.5%	2.3%	0.0%	0.0%	43	4.42
The instructor fostered an inclusive learning environment.	55.8%	37.2%	7.0%	0.0%	0.0%	43	4.49
The instructor effectively explained the concepts and subject matter in this course.	37.2%	55.8%	2.3%	4.7%	0.0%	43	4.26
The instructional techniques kept me engaged in learning.	32.6%	32.6%	20.9%	14.0%	0.0%	43	3.84
The instructor checked for student understanding of the concepts presented in the course.	46.5%	41.9%	7.0%	4.7%	0.0%	43	4.30

Overall Questions



College, School, or Unit Questions



Comment Questions

Identify aspects of the course that were the most effective in helping your learning.

Comments
slide organization, kcs and hws and hws number of hws
I enjoyed the course videos as well as the integration of powerpoint slides and R studio
Lectures thoroughly explained material with examples
The knowledge checks, exit tickets, and homeworks were all really effective in helping my learning. Also, Dr. Bolfarine provides real world examples which helped me gain a better understanding of abstract concepts. Also, extra credit is amazing.
All of the KCs and HWs were very helpful in understanding the topics. The grading was structured so that I could focus on learning the material, not stress about how it's graded.
The homeworks very really good
Having the homework assignments allow multiple attempts ensured that the coursework was truly about learning, not just maximizing a grade. This allowed me to take my time, learn from my mistakes, and develop a deeper understanding of the topic. The small exit tickets at the end of each class was also very helpful in reviewing the content we had just learned. Specifically, it tested a more conceptual understanding of the topic, helping students truly know whether they understood the lecture or not. Professor Bolfarine's walk through of the questions helped confirm or reshape our thoughts on the topic.
Professor Bolfarine was always available after class and during office hours to answer any questions that students had regarding the course content. Not only was he very kind, but he created an enjoyable learning atmosphere, especially for a class that was typically longer than most students normally had.
The homework questions were very reflective of test questions which was helpful for studying and preparing during the semester. Additionally, the practice tests provided during before each exam were helpful to study.
Professor Bolfarine walked through the concepts in class, and allowed for questions.
The homeworks and knowledge checks helped keep me on track with the content.
HW and KC assessments
The in-class activities were easy to follow and helped with learning
I found the fact lectures were recorded for rewatching at a later date to be helpful along with the multiple layers of assignments (KCs and homeworks).
The knowledge checks and post lecture quizzes were very helpful.
I believe that the structured homework was helpful in my learning as I could predict when I could complete the KCs and Homework.
I felt the cheat sheets and the slides were mostly helpful for studying.
I liked the walkthroughs and the recorded classes.
The knowledge checks at the end of each lecture, where we could collaborate with others, proved helpful in grasping the concept lectured.
Walking through the slides each class and staying after to help us with any questions we struggled with.
Professor Bolfarine is very considerate and offers a lot of learning opportunities if a student is struggling. The consistent KC's and homework assignments with emphasis on learning instead of grades was very encouraging.
Plenty of practice exams and materials before important tests.
Great lectures, assignments including KCs and HW, real-life example scenarios to make analysis, etc.
Class was very structured, which I appreciated. Slides were also very nice

Identify the aspect of the course that you found most challenging, why you found it was challenging, and suggest one thing that could be done to help future students meet that challenge more effectively.

Comments
understanding lectures sometimes and wish there was more practice exams, give more practice exams.
Some of the material was very numerical and had lots of mathematical concepts
Homeworks were sometimes challenging, but nothing too challenging
I think the most challenging part was the homeworks. I think having more structured notes surrounding specific examples can be helpful.
The exams. As they should be. It's just studying and understanding the material, but it does feel like a lot.
The final was pretty hard
There were no aspects of this course that I think need changing. It may be helpful to have more than one practice midterm or final, but other than that it was a very well constructed class.
The most challenging part of the course was definitely the homework assignments, as some of the questions could be a bit difficult to understand and were more complex than the problems that we had completed in class. However, with help from TAs and Professor Bolfarine, they were definitely doable.
The concepts of the course can be challenging because they require a deep understanding of the fundamentals provided by STA 301. I think that Professor Bolfarine does a wonderful job helping students understand; however, practice problems can be provided or more interactive elements can be included.
I liked the slides, but having a textbook could help give the course more structure and give us something to refer to for the homeworks.
N/A
A study guide could be helpful – like a page of notes summarizing everything
One thing I found challenging was understanding the why behind some of the coding done in the class which could maybe be helped with additional material to review to understand the why behind certain models were constructed they way they were.
The exams were a bit challenging and required a lot of study and prep.
I felt that the in-class discussions could have been shorter and that this could have helped the attendance as well.
I felt the homeworks took some time and there wasn't enough exam prep.
One thing that was challenging was having class only once a week – if it was split up, it would be more digestible.
Studying for the exams was most challenging as they were too much information covered during the class. Perhaps, providing a study guide of concepts and materials would have allowed students to be focused.
Keeping us engaged during class was a struggle at times because there wasn't many interactive assignments. Maybe giving more time for us to work in groups to walk through a problem could make the content easier to learn.
Some of the homeworks are a bit difficult, and sometimes when reaching a roadblock it is hard to overcome it. Perhaps a textbook would have been helpful in those situations.
There was no textbook or clear structure of where the course and content was heading. This could be a little bit hard for students to keep up if they fall behind.
Learning how to interpret data and knowing when to use the right function or approach to an ambiguous problem
I think the most challenging aspect of this course was how engaging the class was. Basically everything you learn in class could be easily learned through the slides and the KCs. Going to class had little benefit to learning material. The 2-hour marathon style of this class felt very long and is probably why this class wasn't very engaging.